



SHE MAY NOT BE THE MAIN PLOT, BUT SHE IS AN ESSENTIAL PART OF THE SCRIPT.



(CLOCKWISE FROM BELOW) WITH BRUNI; WITH PREITY ZINTA; WITH SONIA GANDHI; AT THE TRADE FAIR IN DELHI; WITH THE OBAMAS AT THE WHITE HOUSE; AT A BREAST CANCER AWARENESS WALK; AT THE LAUNCH OF INS ARIHANT



worries about sitting at a *gaana* to sing at a friend's wedding. Gursharan does that, as the wife of a prime minister, but without any hangups. She can sit *chaukri maar ke* (cross-legged) with a *dholak* and have fun at weddings," says Malvika Singh, publisher of the magazine *Seminar* and a family friend.

Before she moved to the trappings of Race Course Road, Gursharan insisted on shopping for vegetables

herself as she is convinced that only she can choose the right ones at the right price. If it was the driver's day off, she would drive her husband to the doctor in her white Maruti 800. The car is still parked at the prime minister's residence but now Gursharan has to be content dictating shortcuts to her cavalcade. Interestingly, while both Gursharan and Manmohan took the driver's test together in the US, only one of them

passed. "She is still very triumphant about this," grins Daman.

Suddenly, this middle-class housewife with chutzpah is scoring over global fashionistas parading their oomph. As she accompanies her husband to G-20 and beyond and stands with other first ladies for the traditional group photograph, she does so in a traditional Indian sari and her trademark string of pearls. However, her saris will always have a